

# Part I: Kitchen Basics

## Food Safety



Chris discusses food safety basics while meal prepping including internal cooking temperature requirements for different proteins as well as the refrigerator shelf life of uncooked and cooked meal prep ingredients. Throughout this video, Chris demonstrates how he minimizes his risk of getting a food borne illness by providing the necessary food safety steps he uses while preparing and storing his food.

### Chris's Key Takeaways

Safe Internal Cooking Temperature: Fish – 145°F, Chicken – 165°F, Ground Beef/Bison – 160°F, Steak – 155°F (bacteria only exist on the outside)

Store raw meats for no more than 2 days in the refrigerator.

Vacuum-sealed meats have a longer shelf life and can last up to 2 weeks unopened in the refrigerator.

The temperature danger zone where bacteria growth accelerates is between 40°F – 140°F.

Most meats can last up to 4 days in the refrigerator when properly cooked and cooled.

When storing meat proteins, cool them at room temperature for 10–15 min before storing them on the top shelf of the refrigerator.

Fish is best consumed within 24 hours of cooking to minimize the risk of foodborne illness.

Vacuum-sealed meats have a greater shelf life (1–2 weeks) in the refrigerator before cooking.

Purchase multiple smaller egg white cartons to minimize the risk of foodborne illness.

Insert the temperature probe into the thickest part of the meat to accurately read the internal temperature.

Using a thermometer helps prevent foodborne illness while minimizing the risk of overcooking meats.

When handling different types of raw meats, begin with those that require the lowest internal cooking temperature first.

Always swap out plates and cooking utensils when cooking with raw meat to minimize cross-contamination.

Avoid thawing meats at room temperature to prevent the acceleration of bacteria growth.

Thaw meats overnight in the refrigerator using a tray. To accelerate thaw times, run cool water over securely bagged meats in a sink.